



RESONANCE · CUSTOMER EMOTION ARCHAEOLOGY

# Zomato

A complete analysis of emotional signals, customer segments, unspoken needs, cognitive dissonance, and approved recommendations.

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# Zomato analysis

Zomato is an Indian restaurant discovery and food-delivery platform (zomato.com) for browsing restaurants, ordering food, and tracking delivery, in the food delivery / restaurant discovery category. Frequent public complaints include late deliveries, rude riders, wrong/missing items, refund delays, chatbot-only support, surge and platform fees, and shrinking Gold perks; main competitors are Swiggy and Magicpin.

REVIEWS ANALYZED

50

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

3

UNSPOKEN NEEDS

5

RED FLAGS

22

PIPELINE COMPLETED

1

 CSV validation

2

 Emotion scoring

3

 Customer clustering

4

 Needs analysis

5

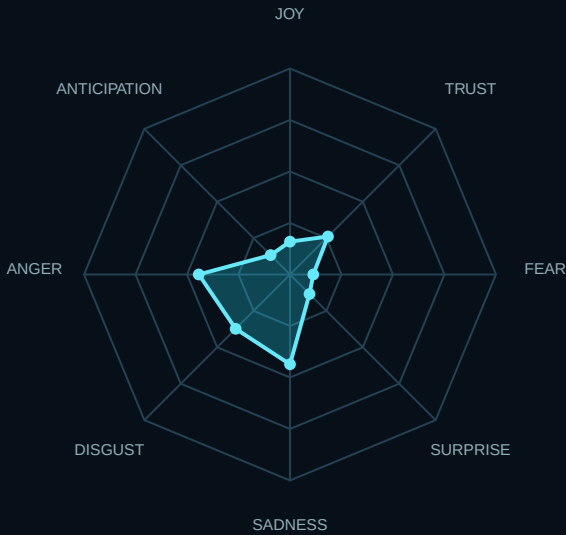
 Human approval

6

 Recommendations

# Complete emotional footprint

Average intensity across Plutchik's eight independent emotional dimensions.



|              |             |
|--------------|-------------|
| Joy          | 0.16 / 1.00 |
| Trust        | 0.26 / 1.00 |
| Fear         | 0.11 / 1.00 |
| Surprise     | 0.13 / 1.00 |
| Sadness      | 0.44 / 1.00 |
| Disgust      | 0.37 / 1.00 |
| Anger        | 0.44 / 1.00 |
| Anticipation | 0.13 / 1.00 |

# Segments (3)

Complete customer archetypes derived from emotional clustering.

## Quietly Delighted

10 reviews · 20.0% · Safety

They feel noticed and in control when the app quietly does its job — late-night biryani, UPI, PNR, scheduled lunches. They stay because reliability feels rarer than it should be on delivery apps.

### DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Joy

Trust

Anticipation

“Ordered at 11:40pm and it still showed up hot. This app has saved more weeknights than I care to admit.”

“Scheduled lunch for a client meeting and it arrived when the app said it would. Rare for delivery apps.”

“Dining photos and reviews beat guessing from Instagram. Booked a weekend table in two taps.”

## Fee-Fatigued Loyalists

22 reviews · 44.0% · Esteem

They keep opening the app but the joy is gone — polite 3-to-4-star reviews hiding real sadness, anger, and disgust at platform fees, shrinking Gold, and a tracking experience that lies about ETAs. They stay because restaurant discovery still works, but a non-renewal is one bad bill away.

### DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Sadness

Anger

Trust

“Dining-out Gold perk is the only reason I'm still subscribed. Delivery benefits keep shrinking.”

“COD disappearing made my parents stop using it. I still order. It works.”

“Community reviews on restaurants are still useful. I just don't trust the delivery half as much as I used to.”

## Burned by Support

18 reviews · 36.0% · Safety

They feel robbed and disbelieved — stuck riders, vanished orders, chatbot loops, scam-looking Google ads, and coupons offered in place of refunds. They have stopped trusting the brand; safety and dignity are the unmet needs beneath the anger and disgust.

### DOMINANT EMOTIONS

Anger

Disgust

Sadness

“Delivery partner asked me to cancel, then cancelled himself. Support called it an operational issue and sent a promo instead of a bank refund.”

“Rider marked me unavailable while I was at the gate. Then they deducted a cancellation fee. Chat contradicted itself twice.”

“Address accepted, payment taken, an hour later they say they can't find it. Why take the money first?”

# Unspoken Needs (5)

Needs implied by emotional patterns rather than explicit feature requests.

## Refund dignity, not coupons

Safety · high confidence · Evidence: Burned by Support

Across the Burned by Support archetype (18 of 50 reviews, 36%) the loudest tell is being offered a 10–60 rupee promo after a missing meal, a wrong order, or a bot loop. Customers cite phrases like "they offered a ten rupee promo. I'm a Gold member. That's insulting" and "do they think I care about a coupon when I already cooked Maggi?" No review asks for a coupon — they ask to be treated as someone who paid real money and lost it.

## A path back to a real human

Belonging · high confidence · Evidence: Fee-Fatigued Loyalists

Fee-Fatigued Loyalists and Burned by Support together make up 80% of the review set, and almost every complaint ends in "the chat sent me a link and ended" or "I can't call anyone to reassign." The implied ask is not a chatbot upgrade but the ability to reach a person who can reverse a wrong charge — especially for Gold members whose fee went up while the perk disappeared.

## Honesty about fees and ETAs

Esteem · high confidence · Evidence: Fee-Fatigued Loyalists

The Quietly Delighted archetype stays because the app quietly tells the truth about ETAs and charges. The Fee-Fatigued Loyalists (44%) and Burned by Support (36%) repeatedly describe rain surges on clear afternoons, platform fees that vanish at checkout, and "arriving soon" windows that last twenty minutes. The unspoken ask is for the app to label its own fees and timing promises the way it labels ratings.

## Recognition of quiet loyalty

Esteem · medium confidence · Evidence: Fee-Fatigued Loyalists

Many long-term customers describe themselves in near-deflated language — "I still order. It works." They keep paying Gold and keep writing 4-star reviews even as fees rise. The pattern is not a request for a discount but for some signal that staying counted: a tenure marker, a Gold promise kept, an apology when a perk is removed.

## Protection from impersonator scams

Safety · medium confidence · Evidence: Burned by Support

One Burned by Support reviewer explicitly says they "almost got scammed" after Google surfaced a fake Zomato care number asking for an OTP. The unmet need is not a chatbot but a loud, in-app warning when a user is searching for "Zomato customer care" — a trust signal that the official app owns that surface.

## Red Flags (22)

Complete set of reviews where the literal wording conflicts with the emotional profile.

### Review 11 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Fine I guess, it works. I open it when I'm too tired to cook and that's about it.”

Hedged 'fine' and 'works' sit on top of clear resignation and sadness.

### Review 12 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Not bad. Delivery is usually okay, I just stop looking at the final amount.”

Polite 'not bad' masks price avoidance and quiet frustration.

### Review 13 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I love it but I probably won't renew Gold. Free delivery vanished the second they put rain fees back on members.”

'I love it' sits beside an active cancellation and real anger over fee changes.

### Review 14 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“App is clean and ordering is easy. A platform fee of almost eighteen rupees on every order is wearing me down though.”

Polite praise sits next to wear-down frustration.

### Review 15 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“Fine. Whatever. Food arrives. I just wish Gold still meant something besides a badge.”

'Fine' and 'food arrives' cloak deep disappointment and quiet anger.



## Review 16 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

"It's not bad. It just works, I guess. Same extra fees as everyone else."

'Not bad' sits over clear sadness and quiet anger about fees.

## Review 17 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

"Restaurant discovery is still the best part. Delivery in my area has gotten slower this year."

Praise for discovery sits beside a real complaint about slower delivery.

## Review 18 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

"It works. I'm not excited about it anymore."

'It works' is a flat, joyless statement that carries heavy sadness.

## Review 19 · 4

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

"Gold is okay I guess if you order a lot. Platform fee still shows up which feels like a joke."

'Okay I guess' disguises real anger and disgust at platform fees.

## Review 20 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Belonging

"Fine. Notifications are spam but I muted them and keep ordering."

'Fine' sits over real annoyance and disgust at spam notifications.

## Review 21 · 3

mixed signals · Esteem

“Packaging charge plus platform fee plus GST and I'm paying more than the food. Not bad food, just a sad bill.”

'Not bad food' directly contradicts the dominant sadness and anger in the bill.

## Review 22 · 4

mixed signals · Safety

“I keep recommending Zomato for dining out even though delivery support has gone downhill.”

Recommends the brand while expressing real disappointment in delivery support.

## Review 23 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Safety

“Onboarding a new address took three tries because the pin kept jumping. After that it's been fine I guess.”

'Fine I guess' sits over genuine frustration with a broken address flow.

## Review 24 · 4

mixed signals · Self-actualization

“Love the menus and photos. Wish power users could hide restaurants that always miss items.”

'Love' is paired with an unmet need for more control.

## Review 25 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Esteem

“It's not bad but I'm comparing every order to walking downstairs. The convenience tax is getting loud.”

Polite 'not bad' covers real anger and sadness about the convenience tax.

## Review 26 · 4

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Tracking used to feel honest. Lately “arriving soon” lasts twenty minutes and I just wait.”

Mild words ('lately') mask deep sadness and anger at broken tracking trust.

## Review 27 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Safety

“Gold auto-renewed and I didn't notice until the debit. Cancellation is buried. Fine I guess, I deserved that for not reading.”

'Fine I guess' and self-blame hide strong anger and disgust at the dark pattern.

## Review 28 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“Dining-out Gold perk is the only reason I'm still subscribed. Delivery benefits keep shrinking.”

Loyalty language sits next to a real complaint about shrinking value.

## Review 29 · 3

positive words negative emotions · Belonging

“COD disappearing made my parents stop using it. I still order. It works.”

'It works' hides real sadness and anger about losing their parents.

## Review 30 · 4

negative words positive emotions · Safety

“Intercity delivery sounded cool until the ETA was a suggestion. Food was edible. I won't do it again.”

'Cool' and 'edible' are small bright spots over dominant sadness and anger.

## Review 49 · 3

mixed signals · Safety

“Community reviews on restaurants are still useful. I just don't trust the delivery half as much as I used to.”

Praising reviews while expressing real distrust of the delivery half.

## Review 50 · 4

mixed signals · Esteem

“I love the app for discovering places. I probably won't renew Gold unless they drop the platform fee and bring the rain waiver back.”

'Love the app' sits beside a conditional non-renewal and real anger.

## Recommendations (5)

The complete set of recommendations generated after human approval.

### Refund dignity, not coupons

high priority · Effort M

Replace promo-credit defaults with an explicit 'refund to original payment method' option on every failed-order flow, and surface the resolution path (amount, method, ETA) above the chat thread so Gold and non-Gold members can see their money acknowledged before any coupon is offered.

### A path back to a real human

high priority · Effort M

Add a one-tap 'talk to a person' escalation that appears after two failed chatbot loops or any wrong-charge dispute, route Gold members and refund cases to a human queue first, and remove the link-and-close chat ending for unresolved cases.

### Honesty about fees and ETAs

high priority · Effort S

Show a single pre-checkout line that totals platform fee, GST, packaging, and surge together with the rider ETA's actual confidence band, and stop rolling Gold perks quietly into the same line so members can see when a waived fee is no longer waived.

### Recognition of quiet loyalty

medium priority · Effort S

Ship a tenure marker on the account page, a Gold changelog that announces every perk change with an apology when a perk is removed, and a yearly 'thank you' credit that arrives without a purchase prompt so long-term users see that staying counted.

## Protection from impersonator scams

high priority · Effort L

Claim and verify the official 'Zomato customer care' search ads and surface an in-app banner the moment a user lands on a support article from a non-zomato.com source, with the verified care number and a warning that Zomato never asks for OTPs by phone.

# Zomato: what customers are really saying

A concise synthesis of the complete Resonance analysis.

Across 50 analyzed reviews, the primary emotional driver is anger. Resonance identified 3 customer segments, 5 unspoken needs, and 22 cognitive-dissonance red flags.

## PRIORITY 1

### Refund dignity, not coupons

Replace promo-credit defaults with an explicit 'refund to original payment method' option on every failed-order flow, and surface the resolution path (amount, method, ETA) above the chat thread so Gold and non-Gold members can see their money acknowledged before any coupon is offered.

## PRIORITY 2

### A path back to a real human

Add a one-tap 'talk to a person' escalation that appears after two failed chatbot loops or any wrong-charge dispute, route Gold members and refund cases to a human queue first, and remove the link-and-close chat ending for unresolved cases.

## PRIORITY 3

### Honesty about fees and ETAs

Show a single pre-checkout line that totals platform fee, GST, packaging, and surge together with the rider ETA's actual confidence band, and stop rolling Gold perks quietly into the same line so members can see when a waived fee is no longer waived.